



English

Stage 8

Paper 1 Non-fiction

2023

Cambridge Lower Secondary Progression Test

Name

Class

Date _____

1 hour 10 minutes

Additional materials: Insert

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **all** questions.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- You should pay attention to punctuation, spelling and handwriting.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 50.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- Suggestions for how long to spend on each section are given in the booklet.

Section A: Reading

Spend 30 minutes on this section.

Read **Text A** in the insert, and then answer questions 1–5.

1 Look at the first paragraph (lines 3–9).

- (a) The writer uses powerful imagery to describe the sounds made by elephants.
Give **one** example.

..... [1]

- (b) Give **one** word that tells the reader that forest elephants are mysterious and difficult to understand.

..... [1]

- (c) Give **one** word that tells the reader that forest elephants are hard to track.

..... [1]

- (d) Look at the last sentence (lines 7–9).
Explain how the last sentence links the first paragraph to the second paragraph.

.....
..... [2]

2 Look at the second paragraph (lines 10–15).

- (a) Why does the writer use direct speech instead of indirect speech?

..... [1]

- (b) How does the writer build up detail in the last sentence (lines 13–15) through the use of punctuation? Give **one** way.

..... [1]

3 Look at the third paragraph (lines 16–19).

Why does the writer use a conjunction in the last sentence?

..... [1]

4 Look at the fourth paragraph (lines 20–24).

- (a) Explain how the sentence beginning *Such insights* connects the fourth paragraph to the third paragraph.

.....
 [2]

- (b) How does the writer connect two equally important pieces of information in the sentence?

..... [1]

- (c) Give **one** phrase that tells the reader that it is not yet certain that the new research methods will be successful.

..... [1]

5 Look at the fifth and sixth paragraphs (lines 25–33).
 Explain how the writer uses the word *songs* in different ways.

.....
 [2]

Read **Text B** in the insert, and then answer questions 6–10.

6 Look at the first paragraph (lines 3–6).
 Explain the difference in structure between the first and second sentences.

.....
 [2]

7 What is *food time is a breeze* (line 23) an example of? Tick (✓) **one** box.

personification ☐

hyperbole ☐

an oxymoron ☐

an idiom ☐

[1]

8 Look at the whole text.

Why does the writer use the word *fingers* to describe part of the elephant's trunk?

Tick (✓) **one** box.

They remove ticks. ☐

They are used for communication. ☐

They can pick things up off the ground. ☐

They are made of bones. ☐

[1]

9 **Text B** is less formal than **Text A**.

How does the writer achieve this effect? Give **two** ways.

-
-

[2]

10 (a) How does an elephant use its trunk? Make notes in the table below.

How does an elephant use its trunk ...	Notes
when drinking?	
when eating?	
when looking after itself?	
at other times?	

[3]

(b) Summarise how an elephant uses its trunk. Use up to **50 words**.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

Section B: Writing

Spend 30 minutes on this section.

- 11** Our hands are one of a human's most remarkable features.
Write an information text about human hands as part of a 'Guidebook for Visitors to Planet Earth'.

You should include information about:

- how humans use their hands in their everyday lives
- some special ways that humans use their hands
- how humans take care of their hands.

Space for your plan:

Write your information text on the next page.

[25 marks]

Stage 8

Paper 1 Non-fiction

Insert



Text A

How eavesdropping on elephants is keeping them safe

A low rumble reverberates from a rainforest clearing. Occasionally, piercing roars and haunting wails emanate from among the trees. These are the calls of forest elephants that inhabit this tropical landscape. Hidden by the dense vegetation, they are the smaller and more enigmatic cousins of savannah elephants. They are more commonly heard than seen, but their diminishing populations are endangered by high levels of poaching. Now, the calls these elusive elephants use to communicate with each other through the thick forests could provide researchers with new tools they need to protect the animals.

5

‘Our goal is to better understand and protect forest elephants, a keystone species roaming the second largest tropical rainforest on earth,’ says Peter Wrege, a biologist who is part of a team attempting to decipher the elephants’ calls. ‘We are using technology to improve their chance of survival and, in doing so, to conserve the biodiversity of their forests.’ The aim: to find the location of the elephants – and the poachers who seek to kill them – so the animals can be kept safe.

10

15

Wrege and his colleagues have collected around 900 000 hours of recordings from central African forests, which include thousands of hours of elephant vocalisations. They have found, for example, that low frequency rumbles keep groups in contact with each other, while long, overlapping rumbles serve as greetings.

Such insights provide not only clues about elephant communication, but also an early warning to rangers that something might be amiss if the sensors pick up on elephant alarm calls or noises made by poachers, such as gunshots and human speech. It remains to be seen, Wrege says, ‘whether technology can make it possible to do this at a truly meaningful landscape scale – tens of thousands of square kilometers where standard methods just won’t work.’

20

But the researchers are off to a strong start. Their largest current project includes a grid of 50 sensors monitoring 1 243 sq km of forest, recording the equivalent of two million songs and calls from the forests every 3–4 months. With the help of a form of artificial intelligence (AI) known as deep learning, analysing this huge volume of recordings, and picking out the 15 000 or so elephant calls, can be done in about 22 days. Wrege and his colleagues are also now testing prototypes for real-time detection.

25

30

‘AI just makes us so much more efficient in all of these things,’ says Lucas Joppa, a chief environmental officer. ‘No human would be able to sit there and listen to two million songs in a language they don’t understand.’

Text B**How does an elephant's trunk work?**

The elephant's trunk must be one of the most amazing things in the entire animal kingdom. Created from a fusion of the animal's top lip and its nose, the elephant's trunk is a multi-functional tool integral to these distinguished mammals' survival, and it is used in almost every aspect of their lives.

5

Incredible engineering

The trunk is composed of 140 kg of flesh, fat, nerves, connective tissue, and over 40 000 muscles grouped around the nasal passages. These taper down to two fingers in the case of African elephants and one finger for Asian elephants.

10

What does the elephant use its trunk for?

In human terms, the elephant's trunk is most like the tongue.

Just like the human tongue, the elephant is able to taste the air thanks to millions of receptor cells in their upper nasal cavity. They can smell just as well as any hunting dog and are able to detect water from 19 km away.

15

Once found, the elephant can draw up to 8 litres of water into their nasal passages at a time. This is then sprayed into the mouth. Water and mud is sprayed over the elephant's body to cool it down on a hot day and discourage external parasites like ticks¹.

If a river crossing is in order, the trunk comes to the rescue once again. Held high above the surface of the water, the trunk is used like a snorkel so the elephant can breathe even when its entire body is submerged.

20

Finger food

Food time is a breeze when you have two highly tactile fingers to pick leaves from the highest branches, snap off twigs or pull up grass, and self-defence is no problem either with a long muscular club at your disposal. An elephant's trunk can lift hundreds of kilograms with ease.

25

Glossary

¹tick – a small insect that sticks to animals

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English

Stage 8

Paper 2 Fiction



2023

Cambridge Lower Secondary Progression Test

Name

Class

Date

1 hour 10 minutes

Additional materials: Insert

INSTRUCTIONS

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INFORMATION

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Section A: Reading

Spend 30 minutes on this section.

Read the **Text** in the insert, and answer questions 1–10.

1 Look at lines 3–4.

What **two** literary techniques does the writer use? Tick (✓) **two** boxes.

a metaphor

☐

a euphemism

☐

onomatopoeia

☐

a simile

☐

rhyme

☐

[2]

2 Look at lines 5–12.

(a) What does the writer use the word *see* to mean in these lines?

..... [1]

(b) The writer uses the sentence openings, *Queeny says*, three times in this section of the text. Give **two** ways this has an effect on the reader.

•

.....

•

.....

[2]

3 Look at lines 13–20.

- (a) These lines are different from lines 3–12.
Give **two** ways they are different.

-
 -
- [2]

- (b) The writer wants the reader to believe that Subhi is good at getting what he wants from his sister.
Give **one** quotation from the text that tells the reader this.

..... [1]

4 Look at lines 21–24. Maá says, ‘*Just little longer, né?*’
What **two** ideas about Maá does this emphasise?

-
 -
- [2]

5 Look at lines 25–28.
Explain how the reader knows that it is a long time since Maá ate a full meal. Support your answer by giving evidence from the text.

.....
..... [2]

6 Look at lines 29–33.

- (a) How does the writer connect this paragraph to the previous paragraph?

..... [1]

- (b) What is the effect of the last sentence of the paragraph (lines 32–33)?

..... [1]

- 7 Look at lines 34–45.
Explain **two** ways that you think Eli and Subhi act as if they are brothers. Support each of your explanations with a quotation.

First way:

.....

Quotation 1:

Second way:

.....

Quotation 2:

[4]

- 8 (a) Look at lines 46–49.
Give **one** example of hyperbole.

..... [1]

- (b) Give **one** phrase that shows that Eli's storytelling skills are having a great impact on his audience.

..... [1]

- 9 Look at the whole text. The way that Queeny thinks and acts is different from Subhi. Explain how you think the writer demonstrates this.
Give **two** explanations and support each explanation with a quotation.

First explanation:

First quotation:

Second explanation:

Second quotation:

[4]

- 10** The writer sympathises with the situation of the characters.
How does the writer do this? Tick (✓) **one** box.

The writer does this by

discussing in detail how emotional each character feels.

☐

giving information about the location of the refugee camp.

☐

using sensitive and descriptive language to set the scene.

☐

introducing a narrator's opinion on the refugees' experiences.

☐

[1]

Section B: Writing

Spend 30 minutes on this section.

- 11** Eli started to tell a story to the children in the camp about a whale.

Imagine that a magazine for young children has invited you to write the rest of the story.

You could write about:

- what happens on this night that makes it different
- what other character(s) to introduce
- how to finish the story.

Space for your plan:

Write your story on the next page.

[25 marks]

E/S8/02

Stage 8

Cambridge Lower Secondary Progression Test

[illegible]

2023

Text for Section A, an extract from *The Bone Sparrow* by Zana Fraillon

Subhi is a nine-year-old boy who has lived almost all his life in a camp for refugees.

Sometimes, at night, the dirt outside turns into a beautiful ocean. As red as the sun and as deep as the sky.

I lie on my bed, and listen to the waves lapping at the tent. Queeny says I'm stupid, saying that kind of stuff. But it's true. She just doesn't see it, is all. 5

Maá sees, though. She can hear the ocean outside, too. 'You hear it, *né?*' I whisper, in the dark.

In the morning, the ground still wet and foamy from where the waves have washed up, I sit and trace the hundreds of animals that have swum all the way up to the tent, their faces pushing against the flaps, trying to get a look at us inside on our beds. Queeny says they aren't real beds, but just old army cots and even older army blankets. Queeny says that a real bed is made with springs and cushions and feathers, and that real blankets don't itch. 10

This morning I found a shell washed up right along with those animals. I breathed in its smell. All hot and salty fish, like the very bottom of the ocean. And even though Queeny doesn't believe, and grunted about when was I ever going to grow up and could I please quit bothering her all the time, she still gave me her last bit of paper and said I could borrow her pen so I could write the words in black at the top of the page. *The Night Sea with Creatures*. I drew a picture as best I could with no colours and paper that curled from the damp. Using her pen and paper only cost me my soap, and I'll steal that back from her later anyway. Sisters shouldn't charge their own brothers for paper. 15 20

I snug up with Maá, careful not to wake her because today is one of her tired days.

When I whisper that it's just about breakfast time and does she want to come eat, I see her eyes open a bit and the smile start on her lips. 'Just little longer, *né?*' she says, in her English that never sounds right. 'I not hungry much, Subhi, love.'

Maá's never hungry much. The last time she ate a full meal and didn't just peck at her food was when I was only nineteen fence diamonds high. I remember because that was on Queeny's birthday and Maá always measures us on our birthdays. By now I am at least twenty-one or twenty-two, or maybe even twenty-two and a half high. I haven't been measured in a while. 25

Maá's never hungry much, but I'm always hungry. Eli, he reckons I must be going through a growth spurt. Eli lives in Family Tent Four with some other families because his family isn't here. It doesn't matter that Eli's older than me by more than Queeny is; he's my best friend and we tell each other everything there ever is to tell. Eli says we're more than best friends. We're brothers. 30

I pull out my shell and show it to Eli. Eli, he's the only one I show all my treasures to.

'Ba sent me another,' I say. 35

Eli looks at me with one eyebrow raised. I don't think he's at all sure that it is my ba sending me these treasures while everyone else sleeps. But if anyone could work out how to whisper up the Night Sea to send a message to the kid he's never met, it would be my ba.

'Your dad needs to work on his messages, because so far not one of us can make out a word of what he's trying to say,' Eli says. 40

I give Eli my shell and he smiles, turning it over and over in his hands. 'Nice one.' Then he sits down in the dirt and pushes it up to his ear.

'Are you listening to the sound of the sea?' I ask.

'I'm listening to the stories of the sea. Do you want me to tell you what I hear?'

And now there are at least ten other kids, all gathered round, listening to Eli tell.

45

'A long way back, when the world was nothing but sea, there lived a whale. The biggest, hugest whale in the ocean. The whale was as old as the universe and as big as this whole country. Every night, the whale would rise to the surface and sing his song to the moon. One night...'

And all of us sit, Eli's story wriggling its way so deep into our brains that it can't ever fall out.

Later, I let Queeny have a listen to my shell. 'What am I listening to?' she says. 'The only thing I can hear is air swishing about.'

50

'That's the sound of the sea,' I tell her.

She just looks back at me. 'Pft. The sea sounds nothing like that.'

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